ZAKHEERA AI SOLUTIONS (PRIVATE) LIMITED

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

Hybrid work, allowances, security and remote rules

Policy ID	ZAI-HR-RH-007
Version	1.4
Effective date	1 March 2024
Policy owner	Human Resources and IT Security
Applies to	Confirmed employees; probationers as stated
Approved by	Chief Executive Officer and Head of Human Resources
HR contact	hr@zakheera.ai | Extension 2200 | HR Helpdesk on the ZakheeraHR portal

1. Purpose and Work Models

ZAKHEERA supports flexible work while protecting collaboration, client service and data security. This policy covers hybrid work, working from home, fully remote roles and temporary work from other locations.

Model	Description	Who
Office-based	5 days in office	Roles needing lab, hardware or client-site presence, and employees in probation unless approved
Hybrid (default)	3 days in office (Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday), 2 days remote (Monday, Friday)	Confirmed employees G2 and above
Fully remote	Works remotely, visits office for quarterly team weeks	Approved roles only, needs Director and Head of HR approval
Temporary remote	Short term remote work for a defined reason	Approved case by case by manager and HR

2. Eligibility

- Hybrid work begins after confirmation (successful completion of probation). Probationers may request up to 1 remote day per week with manager approval.
- Employees with a Rating 2 or below, or on a PIP, must work from office until the PIP is closed.
- Interns and trainees (G1) work from the office unless HR and the manager approve otherwise.
- Roles that require physical presence (Admin, IT hardware support, reception) are excluded.

3. Working Rules for Remote Days

- Be available and responsive during core hours, 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM, and keep your status updated on chat.
- Check in on ZakheeraHR mobile app by 9:15 AM and keep a working camera for team calls unless bandwidth is a problem.
- Work from a safe, private place with a stable internet connection. Public cafes and shared spaces are not allowed when handling client data.

- Teams may change in-office days for a team offsite, workshop or client meeting with at least 3 working days notice.
- Managers must keep hybrid arrangements fair and measure output rather than hours online.

4. Allowances and Equipment

Item	Details
Remote work allowance	PKR 5,000 per month for internet and electricity, paid with salary to approved hybrid and remote employees
Laptop	Company laptop only. Personal devices cannot be used for client or production work
Peripherals	One-time home office kit of up to PKR 25,000 (monitor, keyboard, mouse, headset or chair) for fully remote employees, reimbursed against receipts. Hybrid employees may use Company office equipment
Backup internet or power	Fully remote employees may claim up to PKR 15,000 once per year for a backup mobile internet device or UPS, because of load shedding and outages
Support	IT support at it-support@zakheera.ai. Company-owned equipment is repaired or replaced by IT

5. Connectivity Failures and Load Shedding

If internet or electricity fails during a remote day, the employee must inform the manager immediately and try a backup option (mobile hotspot, nearby co-working space, or office). If work cannot be done for more than 2 hours, the employee should come to the nearest office or request half a day of casual leave. Repeated outages (more than 3 per month) should be discussed with the manager and may change the hybrid arrangement.

6. Information Security Requirements

- Always connect via the Company VPN and keep multi-factor authentication enabled.
- Lock the screen when away. Do not allow family or friends to use the Company laptop.
- Do not print, photograph or store client data locally or on personal cloud drives.
- Use only home or trusted networks with WPA2 or better. Do not use public Wi-Fi without VPN.
- Report suspected incidents to security@zakheera.ai within 2 hours.

7. Working from Another City or Abroad

- Working from another city in Pakistan for up to 10 working days per year is allowed with manager approval 5 working days in advance.
- Working from abroad is allowed for up to 15 working days per calendar year, with Department Head and HR approval at least 20 working days ahead. It is limited to countries approved by Legal and Security, because of tax, data and labour law implications.
- Employees who work abroad without approval may face disciplinary action.
- Relocation to another country on a permanent basis requires a new employment arrangement.

8. Requesting, Changing and Ending Arrangements

Request a hybrid, remote or temporary arrangement in ZakheeraHR under Requests, then Work Arrangement. The manager decides within 5 working days and HR confirms. The Company may change or end any

arrangement with 30 days notice for business, performance or security reasons. Employees may also request to return to the office at any time.

9. Health and Safety, Expenses and Tax

Employees remain covered by Company policies, insurance and the Code of Conduct when working remotely. Work-related injuries at home must be reported to HR within 24 hours. Other home expenses (rent, furniture, personal devices, bills) are not reimbursed beyond the stated allowances.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many days can I work from home?
A: Hybrid employees work 2 days remotely (Monday and Friday) and 3 days from the office (Tuesday to Thursday).

Q: Can I work from home during probation?
A: Generally no. You may request 1 remote day per week with manager approval. Full hybrid starts after confirmation.

Q: Do I get a remote work allowance?
A: Yes. PKR 5,000 per month for approved hybrid and remote employees.

Q: What if there is a power or internet outage on my remote day?
A: Inform your manager, use backup internet if available, and come to the office or take half a day of casual leave if you cannot work for more than 2 hours.

Q: Can I work from abroad?
A: Up to 15 working days per calendar year with Department Head and HR approval at least 20 working days in advance, in approved countries only.

Q: Can I use my personal laptop?
A: No. Only Company laptops are allowed for client and production work.

Q: Who approves fully remote work?
A: The Director and the Head of HR, for approved roles only.